

Notes taken by Megan Mathews on site at the New Lambton Landslide, mainly around the top of Baker St, we also walked down to Victoria St, on Wednesday morning the 4th of February, 2026, with Jeremy Everitt from RCA and Jody Kamminga from 132 Russell Rd.

I (MM) type said notes out this 6th day of February, 2026, into this document out so that they're legible and have context for other readers. Where relevant, I'm also adding further details that I remember.

Wed 4/2/26 8:38 am
 Jeremy from RCA says there's a bit of soil flaking off the top (from behind Jody's house) but... ^{congl. is soft}
 The natural fissures in the rock are ~~are~~ controlling the groundwater flow
 He said the PVC coming out the back of the ~~rock~~ houses is sewer ~~to~~ ^(not mixed up)
~~sewer~~. Jody said does it matter that it

isn't connected? He said no, not ^{said no, not}
~~the sewer~~
 said that there were safety concerns about ~~the~~ ^{less} other stabilisation measures not being installed
 The modelling suggests that it requires a month of rain to move
 I asked Jeremy, who ~~the~~ owns the report? He said that it's an entity, not actually council. In

- Jeremy says, There is a bit of "flaking off" of topsoil and the more weathered material underneath it at the top of the scarp (which at this point was about 4-5 from the rear of Jody's house), but it quickly becomes slightly weathered to fresh conglomerate so one can expect the flaking/erosion process to be very slow.
- Again, Jeremy: The natural fissures in the rock are controlling the groundwater flow (and hence influencing the slope's susceptibility to movement).
- Jody asked, does it matter that some of the PVC pipes that we see coming out of the rear of the houses along Russell Road aren't connected? I got a bit confused in the notes as I wasn't looking at where she was pointing at the time. I came back and fixed my notes up. Jeremy answered that the ones that weren't connected were sewer, so no.
- Jeremy: at the time (last winter, I guess), there were safety concerns around installing any further stabilisation measures than absolutely necessary.
- Jeremy: the modelling suggests that it requires a month of rain to get the landslide to move again (I guess he means to move "substantially", bc he's also said that it's moved a little bit since August).
- I asked Jeremy, who owns *The Geotechnical Report*? (the one that NCC are currently (to my knowledge) telling the residents they will get after Public Works and Transport finish with it, which I guess will be some time in March. RCA were commissioned to write this report. They finished it around October 2025, it went to NCC for review, came back to RCA for an edit, then RCA sent it to Council around November and as far as RCA are concerned, it's finished). As in, who were RCA's client when this report was commissioned, if that's not confidential. The RTA, NSW Public Works and Council all seem to have a stake in it, but surely RCA can

entity, probably a state entity owns it.
 I asked him what the ballast is for. He confirmed it was to track the machinery around. They had to replace it 4 times. Once, the rig slid half a block, lost $\frac{1}{2}$ the holes overall. ~~but still got what they needed~~
 He confirmed the place has moved, as evidenced by the change in lvl of the ballast on the geo lab.

that they still got the data that they wanted, though.

- There now appears to be shallow trenches under the geofab, causing the ballast "roads" to

New cab in BCA
 Council wanted to remove the ballast but some solns require it.
 Jeremy: eg.
 Jody: who's gonna do the solution?
 Jez: I imagine council.
 One soln involves rezoning... Public works... not sure if they're actually a "do-er".
 There was a landslide in Esperance when ~~the~~ I think the council may have remediated

only put one person on the books per job? So who is on the books- who actually **owns** the report? To my surprise, it's not actually Council. Jeremy said that it's some kind of public entity, probably state, who manage the report ownership on behalf of the 3 parties.

- What is the ballast (the coarse, angular, blue-grey rocks everywhere) for? Jeremy confirmed that it was put there, over some geofabric, to allow machinery to track in & out. Over the course of the drilling last winter, they had to replace the ballast 4 times because of the ground conditions. Once, the remote-operated drilling rig slid uncontrollably down from the back of 12 Baker to about 8 Baker (I think he said).
- During the field component of the geotechnical investigation (i.e. last winter), the ground kept closing up their holes and breaking their wells. Overall, they lost about half of their holes and, I assume, they had to be re-drilled. Jeremy said

undulate. Jeremy said that that appearance confirms that there's been movement since the ballast was last laid.

- While talking about the house at 12 Baker St, Jeremy said that there's no damage classification (under AS2870-2011 (Residential Slabs & Footings), I assume) that captures the extent of the damage that we're looking at, and because of that, it's going to be re-written.
- Originally, Council wanted the ballast removed as soon as fieldworks were completed, but some stabilisation(?) "solutions" require it, so it's being left there for the time being.
- Picking up on a mention of a solution, Jody asked who's going to implement it. Jeremy said that RCA included, in their *The Geotechnical Report*, suggestions of all possible solutions, economically and politically feasible and otherwise, in their report, for the client to weigh up and choose one or a combination. But he did engage in

speculation with us and said "I imagine Council (would be implementing any solutions)". One solution that RCA put forward included rezoning (part or all of, I guess) the site. He also speculated that maybe the dept of Public Works would be implementing the solution/s, but he got the feeling that they weren't really do-ers.

- Apparently there was a landslide in Esperance & Jeremy thinks that the Council there did (=executed & paid for) the remediation, but he's not sure & we should look into it.

No repch → rezone the land.
 Did Council tell RCA that they sent out a ranger in 2022 to check out in response to the landslide? Jee said no, he didn't know about it. He found something about 2022, in st. ing & x site. Jee wants a copy of the letter that Council sent to Jody. "He sent Council a before Council issued the demo order for 6 Baker,

- Jeremy: If no remediation works end up being carried out, for whatever reason, it would seem that the land would have to be rezoned.
- (This bullet point is not in my original notes) We walked up where the scarp face becomes lesser in height, near the boundary of 130 & 132 Russell, to observe how the old quarry interacts with the scarp. Jeremy cautioned us to take care over the rounded gravels & sloped surface.
- From our vantage point, Jeremy pointed out the scarp from a landslide in 2020 (his words). He said it passed "right where that (wooden) chair is", and he pointed out some undulations in the ground in mainly 12 Baker St, describing it as the scarp of said landslide.
- Jody & I asked him if he meant to say 2022, bc there was a landslide whose main movement was in 2022, with its scarp in exactly the location he was pointing out. He said no, he had traced this landslide back to 2020 using satellite imagery.

We all decided we must have been talking about the same landslide, but that his investigation must have unearthed more information than we had access to (e.g. I didn't know that movement there was detectable back as far as 2020).

- I asked him to clarify his investigation path regarding that landslide. Surely RCA's own client (or proxy client, as it may be) provided them with all relevant documentation

order to demolish they asked us how would we do it? N we said start from R n work your way down. After that Council saw fit to ~~demolish~~ issue a demo order to 6 Baker. J: We said recommended to do it under x y z conditions me: when did RCA sent this memo?

regarding the site history? Jeremy said no, Council didn't know about that landslide. He just discovered it from his desktop studies and examination of the ground post 2025 landslide. But no, Council didn't know. Jody and I insisted that they did lol. I told him that Council did indeed know- did they not tell RCA that their sole response to the landslide seems to have been to send out a ranger to inspect the stormwater installations in the properties along Russell Road? Jeremy said no, RCA didn't know that. Jody said that she has a copy of the letter that NCC sent to them (Russell Rd peeps) about it. Jeremy said he'd be very interested to see that, personally, so we told him we'd send it to him.

- I asked him to clarify the timeline of the issuing of the demolition order for 6 Baker St. Caroline & Dave, at 6 Baker, were given a demolition order by Council pretty early on. Jeremy said that he wasn't the one who personally wrote &/or sent the memo

to Council, but he was on the team and he can confirm the following timeline: RCA were engaged by Council to respond to the landslide, NCC asked RCA for a memo on how to demolish houses (I'm not clear on the details here- did Council ask "how to demolish the houses along Baker St" or "how to demolish a house along Baker St" or other? Not sure), RCA sent NCC a memo saying, to paraphrase, "best thing to do would be to start up the top

at 12 Baker St and work your way down (so, 10 next, then 8, then 6), chipping away at it, when weather conditions are favourable", and then, after receiving that advice that they had asked for, NCC saw fit to issue a demolition order to 6 Baker St and only 6 Baker St, urging them to demolish asap or risk serious legal action.

J: I didn't send it - but it was before they sent the order to C&D & after the prelim report. Apr 2015, the sewer from 132-130 discon. & HW ~~not~~ resleeved it. HW told RCA. Council funded the stormwater system → Baker after Aug. It was fully blocked. Policies can't cope w climate chg

talking to Jeremy for about half an hour. The last page of notes is a summary of what she told me he said in that time:

- Jody asked him what this report is for, this new report, the one that needs the photos taken.

J told me later: What report? Not clear, & what NCC said. Her house is ^{some} OK, sewer not OK. Provided options to NCC in report... HW can inst. flex. sewer. Fence is 12 Baker → 2.5m & still mv a bit... RCA inform to com who make dec. re. dryer zone. She asked him if the cause had changed & he didn't answer directly but it sounds like it has. Her saying the creek not involved or something. HW got RCA to investigate the sewer in 2022... Nothing really they could do to prevent.

- During his research for *The Geotechnical Report*, Jeremy approached Hunter Water for information. HW told RCA that in April 2015, the sewer from 132 to 130 Russell disconnected, & HW came out & resleeved it. So there have been problems here since 2015 and that's in the report.
- Jeremy said (and is already known to everyone) that after the further rain event and movement in August last year, NCC flushed their stormwater system that lines Victoria Rd & Baker St from about 122 Vic down to the creek. It was fully blocked- full of sediment etc. I add here that I have been told by residents that they have been complaining to NCC about their non-functional stormwater system there for years. I have observed the gutters overflowing and sheets of water coming down people's driveways.
- Jeremy also observed that policies and practises just can't cope with our changing climate.
- I arrived late to site. Jody had already been talking to Jeremy for about half an hour. The last page of notes is a summary of what she told me he said in that time:
- Jody asked him what this report is for, this new report, the one that needs the photos taken. The answer was much like that given in the letter to residents from Wade.
- That reminds me- I asked him (when I was there, of course) if this new, lot-specific report was a variation on RCA's previous job (*The Geotechnical Report*) or if it has a new job number. Jeremy said that no, *The Geotechnical Report* was RCA being engaged by the aforementioned entity. This lot-specific report, RCA have been directly engaged by NCC. It's not a variation on the previous job, it's a new one (but obviously uses data from RCA's previous findings at the site).
- Jody's house is structurally OK. The sewer's obviously not OK though.
- RCA provided options as to how to re-instate the sewer in their report. One option includes using flexible piping.
- The fence at the back of their place that bounds 128 Russell to 12 Baker St has moved 2.5m and it's still moving a little bit.

- RCA inform the committee that make decisions about the site being a danger zone (whoever they are)
- Has the cause of the landslide changed since the last time they spoke? He didn't really give a direct answer but it sounds like RCA have changed the causation story, something about the creek not being involved because it has vegetation and it's not scoured. Note: I didn't hear him say that in person, but if I'm quoting him correctly, then I would add here that I have a lot of evidence showing significant scouring and damage to vegetation. I've also spoken to many residents up & down Curzon & Russell Rds who strongly attest to the dramatically changed nature of the watercourse. Finally, I'd add that only a fluvial geomorphologist (or a hydrologist or a riparian ecologist) can confidently interpret the story the creek is telling us, not a geotechnical engineer.
- RCA came out and investigated the sewer (for HW?) in 2022
- Was there anything that they (residents) could have done to prevent the landslide? Not really.